

19-inch CRT Monitors

If 17-inchers are the standard, 19-inchers are prime real estate. Priced just Rs 2,000 or 3,000 more than their 17-inch counterparts, 19-inch monitors are fast becoming popular. In fact, they are a standard with professional users working with Photoshop, Corel Draw and QuarkXPress. Even avid gamers and 'videophiles' have begun opting for them.

Features

The first thing you'll notice about 19-inch CRT monitors is that they have a much higher bandwidth than the 17-inchers. This translates to flicker-free viewing. Also, the resolutions offered are higher.

Last year's winner, the BenQ V991, was overshadowed by the slew of models this year. The Philips 109P4 had the best specs amongst all the monitors in both dot pitch and video bandwidth. The maximum resolution achievable by last year's winner was 1,600 x 1,200 pixels at 78 Hz—here Hz is the vertical frequency scan rate of the monitor. This year, that's just average, and both this year's Philips models can attain resolutions of 1,920 x 1,440 pixels at 60 Hz. The NEC Diamondtron can go as high as 1,920 x 1,440 pixels at 73 Hz. The entry level Philips monitors offer a dot pitch of 0.25 mm—something not seen in any of the other entry level monitors.

The biggest drawback of 19-inch monitors is their bulkiness; compactness earned points.

The Philips 109P4 has a flat screen with Aperture Grille technology. The only other monitor to offer this technology is the NEC MultiSync 912SB. Here, SB stands for Smart Bright—preset modes of brightness that you can choose between, according to the applications you're working on, such as 'Net surfing, watching a movie or working on a text file. The Philips 109P4 is the only monitor to feature extra RGB inputs, other than the regular D-Sub 15-pin connector.

The LG StudioWorks 910E was the lightest model, but it suffered in terms of features—it didn't even have a full flat screen. The NEC FP912SB is one huge monitor, and has cumbersome OSD controls. In terms of OSD, the BenQ V991 is easy to use and access, and can be set up in no time.

None of the monitors featured any extras such as USB hubs, which offer an option for external connectivity. Speakers were

missing, too. All the monitors came with the standard package of manuals, drivers and warranties along with the necessary cables.

Performance

In our performance tests, we ran the DisplayMate collection of tests. The geometry test was very important for all the 19-inch monitors, since the pin-cushion and barrel distortion is comparatively less than on a 17-inch monitor. Also, since 19-inch CRTs are more popular amongst professionals, precision is a must—if the geometry of a monitor is incorrect or unsymmetrical, it can cause problems when used with engineering or design applications. The Samsung 955DF fared poorly in the geometry test—there was too much variation in the size and shape of the images in the geometrical resolution tests. Even after adjusting the monitor to give the maximum screen area, the Samsung



Philips 109P4

The battle for the performance title was tight. The NEC MultiSync 912SB was always on the heels of the Philips 109P4, throughout the gruelling tests. The NEC put in a very commendable performance, and deserves special mention, but there's only one spot on the top.



The Philips 109P4 deserves our crown of best performing 19-inch CRT monitor, with features and performance that are second to none. It has an Aperture Grille picture tube, which is FFST and guarantees excellent image quality.

The 109P4 looks great. It's also the only monitor to offer external RGB connectors, and is feature-packed, though more, such as a USB hub would have been welcome.

This monitor zoomed through all our tests. The resolution offered is one of the highest, and colours are sharp and vivid. The contrast is very good, and the monitor is suitable for any application you can think of. The only grudge is the OSD controls, which need some effort to get used to.

We suggest that you look no further if you want a high-performing monitor at a decent price. Ideal for any desktop!

+ Aperture Grille, looks great

- OSD controls take time to get used to

Price: Rs 18,500

